Tagata Moana Policy

Vision

The self-determination of tagata moana is upheld and whakapapa connections are recognised across the Pacific.

Summary

In this policy, we strengthen the community and cultural connections of those who live in the islands and those who call Aotearoa home. We support the rights of tagata moana[1] to decolonise and reindigenise their identity, including the use of their own Indigenous names.

Values and Principles

Te Tiriti o Waitangi: We prioritise the use of tagata moana (people of the sea) to reflect our historical and whakapapa connections to tangata whenua (people of the land). This rich tapestry of interactions and relationships forms the foundation for solidarity with Indigenous Peoples across the Pacific.

Non-Violence: We recognise that tagata moana have always resisted Western imperialism and colonisation, and have their own cultural practices for conflict resolution and peace-making.

Appropriate Decision-making: We express solidarity with Indigenous movements and small independent island nations. We recognise the tradition of movements such as the Nuclear Free and Independent Pacific (NFIP) and independence struggles such as those in West Papua and French-occupied Polynesia.

Ecological Wisdom: We recognise the ancestral wisdom of tagata moana to care for the moana, and the flora and fauna of their islands and waters.

Social Responsibility: We uphold the collective rights of tagata moana to health, education, justice, housing, and democracy in Aotearoa and in the islands.

Strategic Priorities

The Green Party's strategic goals include:

> *"As a Party we strive to create a more connected, compassionate and equal Aotearoa, free from structural biases that discriminate against groups and individuals. We want an Aotearoa that draws on our shared wisdom to meet the needs of all."*

[1] There are many ways to describe the Indigenous Peoples of the Pacific Islands. We use tagata moana interchangeably with Pasifika and note the word 'Pacific' is not an Indigenous term. We note that the word Pacific is a European word and support efforts of Indigenous Peoples to decolonise and reindigenise identity. When referring to specific communities in the Pacific we will prioritise the indigenous names they themselves use as consistent with the indigenous right to self-determination.

Actions in this policy that work towards this include:

- Support climate action led by and centred around Indigenous leadership, and relationships between tangata whenua and tagata moana. (8.1)
- Build communities with houses designed for multi-generational family units and with greater access to public transport and other public amenities. (4.1)
- Promote Pasifika-led health-care models based on tagata moana concepts, practices, and values. (3.1)
- Dismantle the Recognised Seasonal Employer[2] (RSE) scheme and replace it with a scheme that gives Pasifika workers access to residency pathways, fair wages, housing, and essential services. (7.1)
- Develop equitable and culturally-appropriate pathways and programmes for students, for tertiary and other education. (2.4)

Connected Policies

This policy is connected to the following policies: Immigration, Rainbow, Education, Marine, Global Affairs, Climate Change, and Housing and Sustainable Communities.

Policy Positions

1. Arts and Culture

Issues

We recognise the expertise of Indigenous knowledge and language holders of our Pasifika communities. Indigenous knowledge refers to the understandings, skills, and philosophies developed by societies with long histories of interaction with their natural surroundings. It encompasses language, systems of classification, resource use practices, social interactions, ritual, and spirituality. We support an equitable approach to:

1.1. Establish and maintain tagata moana cultural hubs and Pasifika festivals across the country.

1.2. Fund programmes that revitalise and maintain Indigenous Pāsifika languages and dialects.

1.3. Develop and maintain vocational pathways for tagata moana artists and their collaborative initiatives.

1.4. Record and research Pāsifika histories by Pasifika peoples.

2. Education

Issues

Language and culture helps to build an educational foundation that supports the identities of Pasifika learners, within and outside of the education system or Pasifika Language Weeks.

[2] Immigration New Zealand - Recognised Seasonal Employer

2.1. Develop teaching and learning resources around tagata moana knowledge systems, such as traditional Vaka voyaging and star navigation, that include outdoor education and practical experience on the water.

2.2. Amend the Teaching Council criteria of measuring Pacific Teaching qualifications to allow bilingual Pasifika teachers employment opportunities in Aotearoa.

2.3. Fund Early Childhood Education Pasifika Bilingual Units, teaching and learning resources, and curriculum support.

2.4. Develop equitable and culturally-appropriate pathways and programmes for students, for tertiary and other education.

2.5. Ensure NCEA credits and Learning Unit Standards relevant to Pasifika Performing Arts can be easily accessed.

2.6. Ensure that children who hold part-time jobs to contribute to their households are provided with sufficient and timely support to continue their education.

3. Health

Issues

Tagata moana face systemic discrimination within the healthcare system, which means they are less likely and less able to access healthcare. Young tagata moana suffer from poor mental health in both their age groups and ethnic identities.

Actions

3.1. Promote Pasifika-led health-care models based on tagata moana concepts, practices, and values.

3.2. Develop and improve access to culturally appropriate, safe, and free health, dental, and mental health care for tagata moana delivered by tagata moana.

3.3. Increase PHARMAC funding to ensure equitable access to address the disproportionate health needs faced by tagata moana.

3.4. Increase access to training for Pasifika nursing, midwifery, and medical students.

4. Housing

Issues

Housing and community design should reflect the cultural practices of tagata moana that ensure that our children and young people grow up with the guidance of their parents, elders, and extended family.

Actions

4.1. Build communities with houses designed for multi-generational family units and with greater access to public transport and other public amenities.

4.2. Develop and implement accessible pathways to Pasifika home-ownership and resourcing Pasifika housing providers.

5. Pasifika Rainbow

Issues

Tagata moana cultures have always been fluid with respect to our conceptualising and practising of gender roles. Traditionally, mahu, vakasalewa, palopa, fa'afafine, akava'ine, fakaleiti (leiti), and fakafifine (or MVPFAFF+) have held places of respect. The colonising forces of Christianity have historically disrupted, eroded their standing, and that of all Pasifika who identify with diverse genders, sexualities, and sex characteristics.

Actions

5.1. Ensure equitable access for MVPFAFF+ and Rainbow Pasifika to education, healthcare, and mental health care that honours all of their identities.

5.2. Support Rainbow Pasifika-led initiatives, organisations, and research projects such as F'INE and the Manalagi Project.

6. Immigration

Issues

Aotearoa New Zealand's policies and practices must now begin to address the historical and contemporary injustices perpetuated in New Zealand's inequitable relationships with other Pacific nations. Concepts and notions such as "deportation," "overstaying," and "aid" are foreign to Oceania. We acknowledge the generations of trauma caused to tagata moana by the 1974-1976 Dawn Raids era whereby both the Labour and National Governments sought to maintain a "white nation state" through racist immigration policies.

Actions

6.1. Actively support Māori aspirations for a Tiriti-based immigration system by devolving resources to hapū, iwi, and whānau to link with Pasifika communities.

6.2. Advocate for visa-free travel to allow for free movement between all Pacific islands and Aotearoa.

6.3. Create a broad Amnesty Programme for people who overstay.

7. Workers' Rights

Issues

For successive generations, tagata moana have been brought to New Zealand only as a cheap labour force. Combatting New Zealand's exploitation of tagata moana workers is very much part of the International Workers' Rights struggle. We affirm the rights of workers to be unionised.

Actions

7.1. Dismantle the Recognised Seasonal Employer (RSE) scheme and replace it with a scheme that gives Pasifika workers access to residency pathways, fair wages, housing, and essential services.

7.2. End the Pacific Pay Gap.

8. Climate Justice

Issues

Environmental and climate challenges are inherently social justice and human rights issues and are linked to the tradition of Indigenous Peoples' movements in the Pacific.

Actions

8.1. Support climate action led by and centred around Indigenous leadership, and relationships between tangata whenua and tagata moana.

8.2. Support global action that supports small island nations already experiencing climate catastrophe.

8.3. Ensure workers from communities on the frontlines of climate change are prioritised as part of a Just Transition.

8.4. Ensure that tagata moana have active representation on He Pou Rangi, Aotearoa New Zealand's Climate Change Commission.

8.5. Finance climate change mitigation and adaptation, loss and damage compensation for Pasifika communities.

9. Democracy

Issues

The political system in New Zealand does not widely or substantially represent tagata moana, and therefore, many do not engage in mainstream democracy.

Actions

9.1. Resource "by tagata moana for tagata moana" mentoring and leadership development programmes.

9.2. Support culturally safe outreach to tagata moana communities who have low voter enrolment.